

Brainstorming Strategies

Listing:

Make a list of all the ideas related to the topic and categorize them

Check which are within the scope

Arrange the ideas based on importance

Write sentences on each idea

Idea mapping:

- Topic in a circle at the center
- Related main ideas above arrows surrounding the circle
- Further the ideas by adding details to each one
- Verify and select (and reject)
- Create connections
- Write sentences

Annotated bibliography:

- Create a list of published research articles related to the topic
- Use Google Docs
- Jot down the relevant points from each one
- Create categories and organize the points
- Write and make connections

used for research articles

Knowing Databases and Reliable Sources of Information

- Databases: Google Scholar, JSTOR, Researchgate, SCOPUS, and Web of Science

- Publishers: Cambridge University Press, Oxford University Press, Springer Nature, Sage, Routledge, Elsevier, Blackwell, IEEE, and other university presses
- Journals listed in SCOPUS/Web of Science
- Paid or free: Requesting authors to share their published work
- Avoiding Wikipedia: Unreliable information

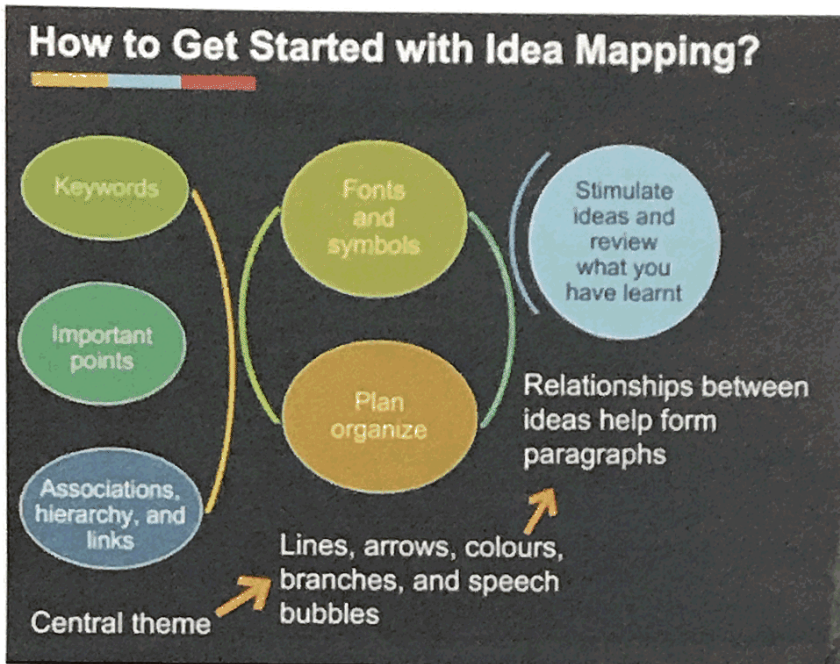
How to Conduct an Effective Search Online

- Using the right keywords relevant to the topic - saving time
- Using multiple resources for the topic: cross-check the information presented improving validity and reliability of presented information
- Keeping track (bookmarking) of the sites visited and used in writing - saving for future reference
- Knowing the best academic journals and resources in your area/field - avoiding false information
- Using the information as per copyright laws avoiding plagiarism
- Going through the references in research articles -> gaining expertise in the area
- Providing the correct URLs used in the writing - helping your academic community and avoiding plagiarism allegations

Why Do We Create Idea Maps?

Visualizing —> Staying focused. —> Drawing strong conclusions

Break down ideas + Group ideas together = identify connections



Kinds of Idea Connections

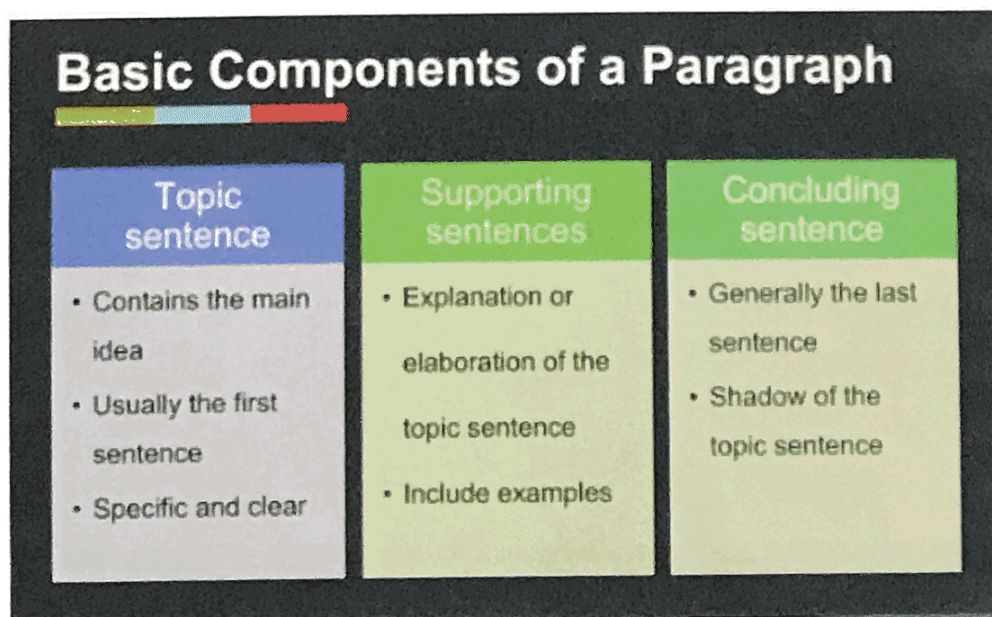
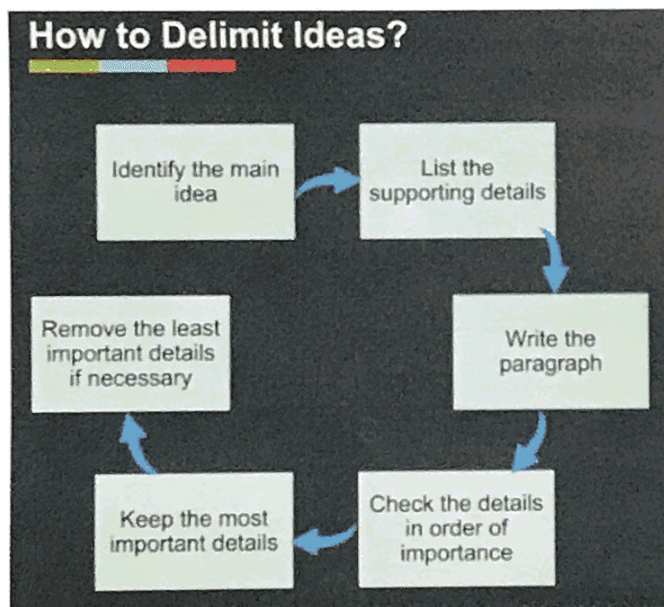
- Familiar and unfamiliar ideas
- Claims, evidence, and explanations in an order
- Comparison between/ among ideas
- Cause and effect relationship
- Facts and details
- Critical and general ideas

What Is Delimiting?

- Narrow down the scope of the paragraph
- Including content that is adequate
- Deciding the depth of the presentation
- Setting boundaries
- Avoiding unwanted elaboration

Why Delimit?

- Staying focused
- Improving reader engagement
- Achieving writing objectives
- Making content more accessible



Features of a Paragraph

- A whole in itself-complete
- Length can vary
- Defining, classifying, comparing, persuading, describing a process, contrasting, and cause-and-effect
- Signposting to maintain coherence
- Academic paragraphs: citations

Example of a Paragraph

A place can be considered to be haunted for various reasons. *First*, people who visit or occupy the place feel the presence of a spirit with a sense of some unfinished activity. The spirit may be seeking closure. *Secondly*, people may interpret activities that can be otherwise explained by science, for example, the sudden burst of wind inside a house, as acts of a spirit. *Lastly*, an abandoned place is often misinterpreted as haunted. It may be a good idea to verify the truth behind the place before accepting it as haunted.

Introduction States the topic sentence

Body Expands the main topic

Conclusion Brings the paragraph to an end

What Is a Topic Sentence?

- A paragraph usually begins with a topic sentence
- Introduces the main idea of the paragraph or tells what the text is about
- The writer must identify the main idea of the text to write an effective topic sentence
- A good paragraph consists of sentences that connect back to the topic sentence; therefore, it must be clear and precise
- Topic sentences are essential as they define the content that will be written further, giving it flow and clarity

Parts of a Topic Sentence

- The topic sentence of a paragraph contains two parts:
a topic and a main/controlling idea

Example

Chocolate consumption is associated with many health concerns.



Topic



Controlling idea

Weak vs. Strong Topic Sentences

Weak

General sentences are broad statements → weak
Example: Books are a very good source of knowledge.
Which books does the writer want to discuss?

Factual statements: Siberia is one of the coldest inhabited places.

Strong

Specific sentences give details about the topic, which are further explained → strong
Example: **Sci-fi books** are my favourite genre of books. These books are about....

Examples of Supporting Sentences

Topic sentence—India is a hospitable country to visit.

Supporting definition-

This means that Indians are extremely friendly and welcoming to guests.

Supporting explanation-

Here guests are considered as gods. Indians treat their guests with utmost care as part of their duty toward their culture.

Supporting example-

Several foreign travelers, including Fa-Hien and Hiuen Tsang, have mentioned how they were treated in their travelogues.

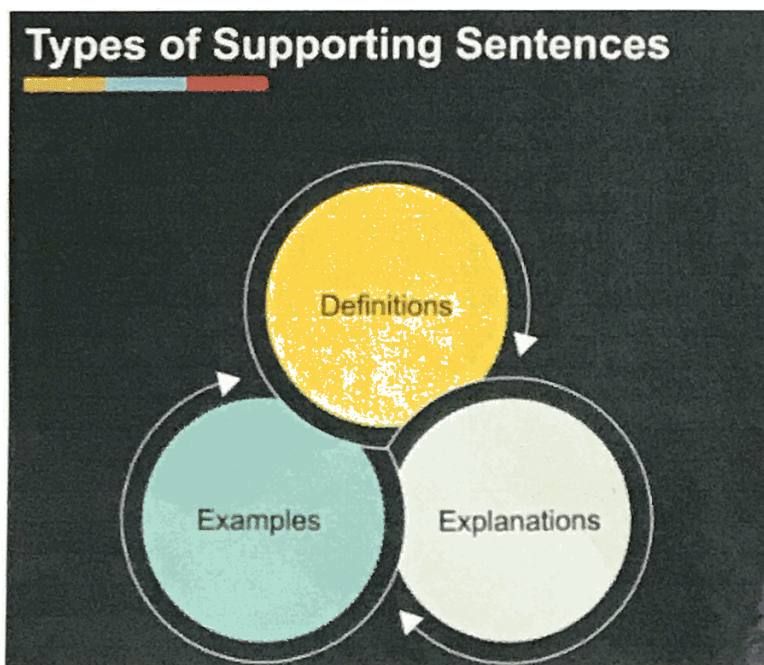
Identify the Supporting Sentences

- Topic sentence: AI has put us under tremendous risks.
- I use AI. ❌
- AI-powered weapons can doom humans. ✅
- Social manipulation is facilitated by AI. ✅
- Governments across the world use AI for monitoring which amounts to an invasion of privacy. ✅
- AI has several merits and demerits. ❌
- AI mediation is determining our communication. ✅

What Are Supporting Sentences?

- Supporting sentences usually follow the topic sentences
- They elaborate more on the ideas expressed in the topic sentence
- They provide the argument/evidence to support the ideas stated in the topic sentence

Types of Supporting Sentences



Writing a Good Concluding Sentence

- If you adopt these methods, you will never procrastinate.

P

- Young people can easily slump into depression if they have a bad lifestyle.

W

- Therefore, Switzerland is the most peaceful place in the world.

O

- Gambling will end your happiness unless you end your gambling habits.

W

What Is a Good Concluding Sentence?

- Usually, the final sentence of a paragraph
- Serves as a reminder to the reader of the main idea
- Reemphasizes the controlling idea
- Sums up the whole or summarizes the paragraph
- Avoid the introduction of any new idea
- Avoid repetition of sentences or phrases used earlier

Writing a Good Concluding Sentence

Concluding sentence

Opinion

Warning

Prediction

What Is Signposting?

Words and phrases to guide the reader while they read the content of your text

Two main types

What Is Signposting?	
Major Signposts	Linking Words/Short Phrases
• Introduction • Conclusion • Main arguments • Direction of the argument • Opening phrases • Closing phrases	• Words connecting ideas/sentences

Kinds of Signposts in Paragraphs

- Conjunctions are like signposts that help the reader to follow the text further
- Verbs can be used as signposts: Define, assert, claim, state, prove, and so on
- Signposts used in the topic sentence can be used in the concluding sentence in their past tense.
- Example:

Topic sentence: This essay will argue.....

Concluding sentence: As the arguments provided.....

Importance of Signposting

Signposts serve the following purpose in academic writing

Emphasize the arguments and transitions in the text

Establish relationships between sentences in a piece of text

Help maintain coherence in the paragraph

Articulates the structure of the writing

Organizes the text

What Is Signposting Of Order?

- Function as guides for the reader.
- Provide a 'roadmap' to help keep track and anticipate the order in which you will present content.
- Remind the reader about important information and predict questions.
- Useful when writing introductions and conclusions and when transitioning from one idea to another.
- Useful when mentioning the procedures and methods that you will use/have used.

Signposting Words Of Order

Listing:

Draw attention to the overall structure

First/firstly
Second/secondly
To begin with
Following this
Afterward
Then
Next
Lastly
Finally
To conclude

Referring backward:

Reiterate important information

Initially
As we have seen
As previously discussed
Prior to this
As discussed previously
As demonstrated above
As indicated earlier

Transitioning between points:

Facilitate readers to locate themselves within the text

Next
It is now necessary
Turning now to
This section identifies
Moving on to
Having considered...we will now consider

Referring forward:

Allows the reader to anticipate what they will be reading ahead

As will be explained later
In the following section
As we shall see
As explored below

What Is Signposting of Relations?

- Display the logic within the steps of your argument
- Highlight the relationship between ideas used
- Draw attention to how you are identifying cause and effect
- Emphasize your method of identifying similarities and differences
- Highlight summaries, important pieces of information, examples etc.

Signposting of Relations

Addition:

shows connection to previous point

Another
To elaborate
What is more
As well as

In addition
Additionally
Also
Further

Illustration:

examples

In particular
For example
To illustrate
For instance
...such as..

Namely
Notably

...as can be seen in..
...as demonstrated
by...
One such

Similarity:
shows the similarities with the previous point

Correspondingly
Similarly
Just as..., SO too

Likewise
In the same way
Complementary to
this...

Emphasis:
identify key information

Chiefly
Mainly
In fact
Importantly
In particular

Furthermore
Indeed
Especially
Mostly
Moreover

Contrast:
show opposition to previous point

Conversely
Rather
Whereas
Even so
Despite this

In comparison
However
Alternatively
That aside

On the contrary

Reformulation:

say it in other words

That is to say
To look at this another
way
In other words

Rather
Put simply
Stated otherwise
Better still

Cause and effect:

show how something is the result/cause of something

As a result
This causes
Hence
For this reason
In view of this

Therefore
This means that
Resulting from this
This suggests that
Accordingly

Summary:

overview of previous points

Overall
In summary
Altogether
On the whole
In brief
To sum up
In short
On the whole
In all
To review

Choosing and Using Appropriate Signposts

- Words used as signposts should be chosen correctly, as different signposts serve different purposes.

Example: in contrast, consequently, however, etc.

All the above words serve different purposes in writing.

- Inaccurate signposts can confuse the reader:

"Coding has simplified qualitative research. It has enhanced the quality of interpretations. Moreover, it has brought challenges to the researcher."

- Unnecessary signposting might appear like an activity to increase the number of words.

Example: "The report has four chapters: Introduction, Methodology, Results, and Conclusion. First, in the Introduction chapter, will.... Then, in the Methodology chapter, will.."

- The focus should be on conveying ideas in an organized manner.
- Excessive use can make the text wordy:

"It may be appropriate to understand the great many ways in which gravity controls our lives"

Coming to the point directly: The noticeable fact is that.../As discussed in detail in the previous paragraph, data science can determine the future of...

- Signposting can make reading tiring if it keeps taking the reader back to many previously mentioned ideas without any justification.

Can hurt precision in writing: "The idea is not only extremely outdated and old fashioned but also in many ways ineffective and unattractive."

- Editing thoroughly before submission- verifying if the message is conveyed is effectively without signposts.